

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in property disputes, residential case management and client-facing legal work. At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team I supported hearing preparation, maintained matter files on iManage and tracked deadlines across several concurrent matters. At Citizens Advice East Berkshire I manage housing and benefits matters from client instruction through to submission, drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and advising clients on procedural requirements. Organised, detail-oriented and experienced in managing confidential files under time pressure.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages housing, welfare benefits, employment, family, debt and consumer matters from client instruction through to submission
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility for Housing Benefit, Universal Credit and related support against statutory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across several concurrent property matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Maintained matter records on iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across competing deadlines; prepared client notes and cost comparisons

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London
Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Amended sections of the memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research
- Became the sole junior supporting the team ahead of a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated external Romanian translations; maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London
Legal Adviser

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London
Legal Intern

June 2022 – Aug 2022

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report and correspondence drafting; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, matter file organisation, deadline tracking, document scheduling and case-file maintenance across concurrent matters